Project 5: The Farmer's Instructions (ETCSL 5.6.3) → Hebrew

▼ Contents

Scope 1

Base text and sources 1

Line numbering 2

The parallels that matter for the commentary (the coordinator's list: "look for", never "translate as") 2

Sources consulted 2

Decisions 3

Where this text departs from Summer and Winter or Hoe and Plough (with the reason) 4

Open decisions 5

Proposals for the corpus renderings 6

Key findings for the commentary 8

Parallels index (Farmer's Instructions) 10

Progress 18

Round 3, run 1 (2026-10-21), creation corpus (`../corpus.md`). Siglum in the corpus parallels index: **FI**.

Scope

An OB Sumerian school text (copies c. 1800 BCE from Nippur, Ur and elsewhere; the composition perhaps Ur III): an old farmer instructs his son through the agricultural year, from the irrigation of the field to the winnowing, and the last lines name it as the instructions of Ninurta, Enlil's faithful farmer. The whole composite: 111 lines (1–111).

Base text and sources

- **Base text (rank 1):** ETCSL c.5.6.3, `../../sources/ETCSL/5.6.3--Farmers-Instructions/transliteration.md` (from the TEI `c.5.6.3.xml`; CC BY-NC-SA). Copy each transliteration line exactly.

- **Lemmas and morph (rank 2):** ETCSL's TEI lemmas (`python3 -I ../../tools/sumerian_workbench.py lemmas|line ../../sources/ETCSL/5.6.3--Farmers-Instructions/c.5.6.3.xml FROM-TO`); ORACC: `../../sources/ORACC/epsd2-literary--Q000784--Farmers-Instructions/Q000784--lemmatised-morph.md` (ePSD2 lemma + morph for every word, same labels; CC0); ePSD2 (`... gloss`).
- **Rank 3:** ETCSL's English translation (`../../sources/ETCSL/5.6.3--Farmers-Instructions/translation.md`), read only after forming the reading of each line. (Other translations: see "Sources consulted".)

Line numbering

ETCSL composite labels, used as entry labels (`### <label>`); checked by `python3 -I ../sumerian_tools.py verify 5`.

The parallels that matter for the commentary (the coordinator's list: "look for", never "translate as")

Gen 3:17–19 (the toil of the ground — here no curse: farming is a god-given instruction); Gen 9:20 (Noah אִישׁ הָאֲדָמָה); **Isa 28:23–29** (the farmer instructed by his God: ploughing, harrowing, sowing in rows, threshing by sledge, "this also comes from YHWH" ↔ FI 110–111); Deut 22:10 (ox and ass), 25:4 (the threshing ox ↔ FI 100); Lev 19:9, 23:22, Deut 24:19 (gleanings, the forgotten sheaf ↔ FI 79–80); Lev 19:19, Deut 22:9 (mixed sowing); Prov 20:4; Ruth 2–3 (the threshing floor at night, winnowing ↔ FI 104–109); the rites against mice and locusts (1 Sam 6:4–5; Deut 28:38–42; Joel 1) and the leaf rust (שְׁדָפוֹן וְיֵרָקוֹן, Deut 28:22; Amos 4:9 ↔ FI 71); the stars that fix the season (FI 38; Gen 1:14); Prov 1:8 (a father's instruction).

Sources consulted

- **Rank 1:** ETCSL c.5.6.3 composite (`../../sources/ETCSL/5.6.3--Farmers-Instructions/transliteration.md`, from `c.5.6.3.xml`); every transliteration line written as `` `@` `` and filled from the base file by script (and every line compared with it: 0 mismatches). Line 1 keeps ETCSL's catalogue note.
- **Rank 2:** ORACC epsd2/literary Q000784 (`Q000784--lemmatised-morph.md`): lemma and morph for every word, cited in each **פירוק**; ETCSL TEI lemmas (`sumerian_workbench.py line`, which also gives the ORACC morph of the same forms elsewhere); "ניתוח שלנו" where ORACC has no parsed instance (mostly the *ḫa-ra-* jussives).
- **Rank 3:** ETCSL's English translation (t.5.6.3), read after forming the reading of each section; every disagreement is in the **תרגומים** bullet.

- **Precedents (grepped by Sumerian word in every annotated file of every corpus, `prec.py`-style search of the transliteration lines):** Summer and Winter (`7-…`: *a-tur₃*, *ki duru₅*, *kislaḫ*, *ĝiš ra*, *ur₃*, *ze₂*, *kud*, *si-il*, *šub*, *tag*, *ki us₂*, *dirig*, *teš₂-bi*, *ma-na*, *sila₃*, the formula of 317); Hoe and Plough (`6-…`: *apin*, *al*, *zu₂*, *a₂*, *šudul*, *ab-sin₂*, *lagab*, *gid₂*, *garadin*, *de₅*, *du₈*, *la₂*, *gu₂*, *gu₇*, *nu₂*, *sumur*, *bar-ed₃-da*, *gašam*, *esir₂*, *giĝ₄*); Bird and Fish (*ki-še-er* `גבול`, *zukum* `דרך`, *ud šu₂-uš-e* `בבוא היום`, *en-nu-uĝ₃* `משמר`); Grain and Sheep (*ud šu₂-uš-e*, *en-nu-uĝ₃*); EWO (*mi₂ zid*, *šibir*, *ĝidru*); Enki and Ninmaḫ 23 (*tu-lu* `רפה`); the Song of the Hoe (*ki dar*, *dub₂*, *saĝ*); Inana's Descent (*gag* `יתד`, *ḫa-za* `החזיק`, *bur₂* `שוחרר`, *dul*, *umbin*, *ḫar-ra-an* `אורח`); Gudea (*kud*, *kur₂*, *sig*, *le-um*, *mul-an*, *iku*); the Curse of Agade 89 (*kid-ma₂-šag₄-ga*); the Sumerian proverbs (*dabin* `סולת`, *šeĝ₆* / *te-en* `יתבשל – אל יצטנן!`, *kalag*); the Ur lament (*di₄-di₄-la₂*); the Ur-Namma laws (*iku* `איקו`, *gur* `כור`); the wisdom corpus (Šuruppag *na de₅*; *nēmelu* `רווח`, *tattūru* `יתרון`); EST (*erbû* `ארבה`).
- **Not available:** Civil 1994 (*The Farmer's Instructions*, the standard edition); what is said of it comes from the coordinator's brief and is marked so. No purchase made.

Decisions

1. **Imperatives and the ethical dative.** Almost every line is an order. *-ab* / *-i₃* imperatives → Hebrew imperative; *ḫa-ra-* / *ḫe₂-* / *ḫu-mu-ra-* jussives → third-person future + `לך` (the Sumerian *-ra-* "for you", kept every time: the text's voice is a father speaking to a son, and the work is done "for you"); *na-* with *marû* → `אַל` + future (36, 37, 39, 74, 79, 80, 86); *nu-* → `לֹא`. One exception: 34 *na-du-un* is a warning ("(otherwise) it will not go"), rendered `לא` (open decision 11).
2. **Recurring frames** kept identical (`renderings.md`, "Formulas"): *-ed-a-zu-ne* (2,) `כשאתה עומד ל־` (41, 48, 74, 100); *ud še … -a* (67, 69, 71, 72, 102, 107) `ביום שהשעורה …`; *ud še … -zu(-ne)* `ביום` (89, 98, 104) `… שאתה`; *sizkur₂ … dug₄-ga-ab* `… אמור – את תפילת …!` (65, 103; 108 `את התפילה …`); *a dug₄-ga-ab* (68–70, 72; 71 `אל תשקה!`) `השקה!`; *tukum-bi* (52, 54) `אם` 88 jussive `יאמרו לך`). 48 = 41 (identical Sumerian, identical Hebrew). *ud* "day" kept as `ביום` (not "when"), so that the reader sees the word.
3. **Reduplication** of a verbal base is doubled in jussives and imperatives (`יכסה ויכסה`, `יסובב ויסובב`, `קצור וקצור`, `ישר וישר`), as in S&W; not in prohibitions (80) or in participles (79, 82).
4. **The shared formula (111)** is copied byte for byte from S&W 317 (`אִכָּרוֹ הַנֶּאֱמָן שֶׁל אֱנְלִיל`; checked by script), and *za₃-mi₂-zu dug₃-ga-am₃* follows §9.5 (`תִּתְהַלָּתְךָ – טוֹבָה הִיא!`).
5. **The gated words** (§9.2–9.6) occur only with their licence: `חרש` with *uru₄* / *apin*; `זרע` with *numun* (49, 52, 68); `קצר` with *gur₁₀* (74, 75, 78); `לקט` with *de₅* (79, 82); `הניח` / `נח` with *ne-ḫa* (87 `תנוח`, 96 `הָנַח`); `עפר` with *saḫar* (61–62); `עבד` with *kiĝ₂*; `טוב` with *dug₃* (18, 111). Avoided: `תניח` (root `נוח`) in 74 → `להושיב` → `לשבת` (20, 34); `תתן` ; `בראשך` / `בראשה` (`ברא`) → `לראשך` / `לראשה` for *samana* → transliterated (71) `סָמָנָה`. `מצטנן` for *te-en* → `יֵרָקוֹן` / `שְׁדָפוֹן` (100); `קר`

6. **Two Sumerian verbs for "instruct" and "glean" are one verb, *de₅*.** *na … de₅* (1, 110) = הוֹרָאָה / הוֹרָה (**2026-10-23 harmonization: שנתן … העצה / נתן עצה, as in every other corpus**; §9.3, ↔ Isa 28:26 יוֹרֶנּוּ, Prov 4:4 וַיֹּרֵנִי); *de₅* alone (79, 82) = לָקַט [cognate via *laqātu*]. The apparatus says so at each.
7. **Measures** (the brief): *giĝ₄* (90 ,51) שֶׁקֶל, *ma-na* (9) מָנֶה, *sila₃* (73) קַב; *ban₂* בָּאן, *gur* גּוּר, *iku* אִיקוּ, *nindan* נִינְדָּן transliterated, values in the notes; *šu-si* אצבע. *{urud}giĝ₄* "axe" (9, 19) is another word in the same sign: קרדום.
8. **Splits by sense, recorded:** *la₂* מתח (10, a net) / שקל / (104 ,99 ,17–16) תלה (90, Akk. *šaqālu*) – as in H&P; *sal* דק (tools, 9, 44) / צר (a "mouth", 11, 67); *a₂* (9.3§) עת / כוח / זרוע; *dirig* (67) עלה על / (25 ,23) עודף; *šub* נפל / (44–43) השליך (50, intransitive); *ĝiš* / (32 ,27) עץ מקל (86, S&W *ĝiš ra*); *ba₉-ra₂* פתח (the threshing floor, 97) / דש (grain, 98, 101; §9.3) / *ĝiš-ba₉-ra₂* מורג; *ki* מקום / הארץ.
9. **New terms** (no precedent in any corpus): *{urud}giĝ₄* קַרְדֹּם (1 Sam 13:20–21); *bulug* מַרְצֵעַ; *šum-me* מַשּׁוֹר (Isa 10:15); *mud* (handle) קַת; *niĝ₂-gul* מַקֶּבֶת (Judg 4:21); *u₂-tag* פטיש?; *usu* אוֹן (Isa 40:29: כֹּחַ stays for *a₂*); *dur* עֲבוֹת (Job 39:10; קשר stays for *keše₂*); *ub* זווית (פינה is H&P's *a₂-ur₂*); *dam* (plough part, "spouse") מוֹט (Jer 27:2); *niĝ₂-kud* טְרִיז; *eme-apin* לשון־המחרשה (the אֵת only in the apparatus); *le-um* לוח [cognate via *lēʾu*]; *ki-saḫar* מקום־העפר; *lag* רָגַב (as H&P *lagab*); *bir₅* אַרְבֶּה [cognate via *erbû*]; *lillan* מְלִילָה (Deut 23:26; אָבִיב is S&W's *šu-nim*); *samana* סָמָנָה; *ku-dun* רֶוַח (= Akk. *nēmelu*, wisdom corpus); *kid₇* גֶּדַע; *mar-gid₂-da* עֲגָלָה (Isa 28:27–28); *mur* מִסְפּוֹא; *nir* זֵרֶה (Ruth 3:2); *dabin* סֹלֶת (proverbs); *ka-gu₇* מאכל פה; *u₂-saga₁₁* אגודות העשב; *ki-ĝar* **מגרש**; the three plough types and *gag-dag₂*, *ka-šu₂*, *ab-ki-iz*, *ba-an-du₈*, *suḫub₂* transliterated.
10. **Echo control:** no Hebrew word was chosen for a parallel. (49) שָׁם is the reserved rendering of *ĝar* (and Isa 28:25 has וְשָׂם); (9) השווה is H&P's *sa₂* (and Isa 28:25 has שְׂעֹרָה), מוֹרַג, עֲגָלָה, גֹּרֶן, זֵרָה, אֲלַמָּה are the plain Hebrew words. Rejected because they would import a verse the tablet does not have: שָׁמַר (70), אָבִיב (53), אֵת (71), יֶרֶקוֹן / שְׁדֵפוֹן (משמר עשה :6 follows the corpus's *en-nu-uĝ₃*), מוֹסָר, (הוֹרָאָה :110) תּוֹרָה (עֲבוֹת :24, so that Prov 1:8 is not echoed), זְרוֹעַ נְטוּיָה (21 is only זרוע חזקה, literal).

Where this text departs from Summer and Winter or Hoe and Plough (with the reason)

- *gur* (92 אורח שובך) = שוב "return" (laments' *gur* = שוב); S&W 32, 91 has *gur* = הקיף "turn around". Split by sense.
- *{ĝiš}mud* = קַת (a handle: 17, 34); H&P 86 has גזע (stumps in the field). Split by sense (ETCSL lemma "stump (handle)").
- *us₂* = צד (51 ,46: a measure, "side, length"), (61) סמוך; *ki us₂* = (102) הודבק אל הארץ follows S&W.
- *ḫa-za* = החזיק (Inana's Descent), not אחז: אחז is S&W's *dab₅* (absent here), and *ḫa-za* is probably a loan of Akk. *aḫāzu* (the cognate of אחז) – open decision 13.

- *tu-lu* = רָפָה (Enki and Ninmaḫ 23); S&W has רפה for another word (*ḫu-nu*) – open decision 12.
- Everything else shared with S&W / H&P is followed: *a-šag₄* שדה, *gana₂* חלקה, *kislaḫ* בּוּר, *ab-sin₂* תלם, *a-tur₃* תלם־המים, *ki duru₅* מקום לח, *apin* מחרשה, *al* מעדר, *šudul* עול, *gud* שור, *zu₂* שן, *zar* אלומה, *garadin* גדיש, *de₅* לקט, *gur₁₀* קצר, *ĝiš ra* במקל חבט, *ur₃* גרר, *ze₂* תלש, *kud* נחתך, *si-il* פילח, *tag* נגע, *šub* השליך, *ĝar* שָׂם, *sig₁₀* שָׂת, *gu₂* שפה, *gid₂* האריך, *dub₂* ניער, *du₈* פרש, *gu₇* האכיל, *nu₂* השכיב / שכב, *sumur* כעס, *mi₂ dug₄* טיפח, *esir₂* חֵמָר, *sila₃* קב, *ma-na* מנה, *giĝ₄* שקל, *ki-buru₁₄*-type words (none here), *engar zid* (the formula).
- *{ĝiš}ninda₂* (the seeder funnel, H&P's מַשְׂפֵּךְ, H&P open decision 11) **does not occur** in the FI composite: the seeder-plough is *apin* throughout (41–53); the funnel is mentioned only in the notes.

Open decisions

1. **Line 1:** ETCSL and ORACC read a name *Ud-ul-uru* (transliterated אוּד־אוּל־אוּרוּ, "the ploughman of distant days"); Civil 1994 reportedly reads "in days of old a farmer (instructed his son)". To be checked against Civil when available.
2. ***na de₅*** = הוֹרָה here (§9.3), but נתן עצה in the Instructions of Šuruppag (wisdom corpus) and in the flood corpus's citation of the same line – the same Sumerian phrase. Proposal: הוֹרָה in all corpora (it keeps Isa 28:26 יוֹרֶנּוּ and Prov 4:4 וַיֹּרֵנִי visible), or keep the split by genre. **Settled 2026-10-23 (`harmonization--2026-10-23.md` row 13): נתן עצה here too.**
3. **Settled by the coordinator (2026-10-22): כֹּר [cognate] (line 29).** ***gur*** (capacity): transliterated גּוּר by the brief; the Ur-Namma laws have כור – the real cognate (Sum. *gur* > Akk. *kurru* > 1 כֹּר Kgs 5:2). Proposal: כֹּר corpus-wide, [cognate].
4. **Settled by the coordinator (2026-10-22): תהילתך – מתוקה היא! (as Enki and Ninmaḫ 141; §9.5 updated).** ***za₃-mi₂-zu dug₃-ga(-am₃)*** = תְּהִלָּתְךָ – טוֹבָה הִיא! (§9.5, here) vs תהילתך מתוקה! (Enki and Ninmaḫ 141; Inana's Descent 412). One rendering for the closing formula across corpora.
5. ***ki-ĝar dug₄*** (8, 91) **למגרש עשה**: meaning uncertain (ETCSL "establish / mark the limits").
6. **90** *lu₂ še la₂-la₂* = שוקלי השעורה (weigh, Akk. *šaqālu*) vs ETCSL "barley carriers"; and "thirty shekels" unexplained.
7. **82–83:** ETCSL reads "gather your helpers and gleaners … and lay down the sheaves"; the grammar also allows "for your weak ones and gleaners … make (them) lie at the sheaves" (*zar-re-eš₂*), which is the Ruth 2–3 parallel. Our Hebrew (קטני־האון …, לאלומות – הַשְׁכֵּב (ל)?!) keeps both readings open. ORACC also allows a temporal *-zu-ne* in 82 ("when your strength is small"). Civil's reading, reportedly a provision for the gleaners, should be checked.
8. ***samana*** (71) transliterated (סָמָנָה); alternatives חֲלַדָּה (rust) or a biblical blight word (rejected: echo).
9. ***lillan*** (70) מְלִילָה: the sound resemblance *lillan* / מְלִילָה is accidental (noted); שִׁבֹּלֶת is the neutral alternative.

10. ***dur₂-dur₂*** (100) להושיב (literal "make sit") vs ETCSL "make trample"; ***ud 5-am₃*** (96) "five days" vs ETCSL "a few days"; ***ud šu₂-uš-e*** (88) בבוא היום (corpus) vs ETCSL "daily".
11. **34** *na-du-un*: לא תלך (warning) – or prohibitive אל תלך (the rule *na-* = אַל)?
12. **One root for two Sumerian words:** *te-en* הצטנן (proverbs; here 108) and *sed₄* D צינן (S&W); *tu-lu* רפה (here, E&Nm) and *ḫu-nu* רפה (S&W); *ḫa-za* החזיק and *kalag* חזק (both here, 20/34 and 21).
13. ***ḫa-za*** החזיק (Inana's Descent) – or אָחַז [cognate, if *ḫa-za* is the loan of *aḫāzu*], which S&W uses for *dab₅*?
14. ***bulug*** מַרְצֵעַ here (a copper tool) vs EWO יָתֵד (a peg); and *gag* יָתֵד here (= Inana's Descent) – so EWO's *bulug* and this *gag* share יתד.
15. **Uncertain lines** translated with ? or *italics* and the alternatives in the apparatus: 8, 10–11, 13, 28, 33, 35, 42, 45, 47, 56, 59, 71–72, 79, 83, 91, 97, 101, 106.

Proposals for the corpus renderings

The third text of Round 3 run 1. New terms a later Sumerian (or Akkadian) farming text will need, with the lines here:

Sumerian	Hebrew	Tag	Lines	Notes
na … de₅	נתן עצה; העצה … שנתן (2026-10-23 harmonization; was הוֹרָה; הוֹרָאָה)	[equivalent] ↔ ישעיהו כח:כו; משלי ד:ד	1, 110	§9.3; open decision 2 (Šuruppag), settled.
sizkur₂ X dug₄	אמור! – את תפילת X		65, 103, 108; 88	§9.4 confirmed as a formula.
uru₄	חרש (also of the seeder-plough's "sowing")	[equivalent] ↔ ישעיהו כח:כד	41, 48, 55, 56, 59	ORACC "sow".
{urud}giĝ₄ (axe); *bulug*; *šum-me*	קרדום; מרצע; משור	[equivalent] ↔ שמואל א יג:כ	9, 19	
usan₃; *gag*; *{ĝiš}mud* (handle); *niĝ₂-gul*	שוט; יתד; קת; מקבת		16, 17, 33, 34, 44	
usu	אוֹן		30, 82, 101	כֹּחַ for *a₂*.
dur; *tu-lu*	עֲבוֹת; רפה	[equivalent] ↔ איוב לט:י	24, 54, 57	
ub	זווית		12	
le-um	לוח	[cognate] (*lēʾu*)	45	(Gudea: לוח־כתב.)
eme-apin; *niĝ₂-kud*; *dam* (plough)	לשון־המחרשה; טריז; מוט	[equivalent] ↔ ישעיהו ב:ד	44, 53	
ki-saḫar; *lag*	מקום־העפר; רגב		60–62	
bir₅	ארבה	[cognate] (*erbû*)	66	Note the {mušen} determinative (↔ Lev 11:20–22).
lillan; *samana*	מלילה; סָמָנָה		70, 71	Open decisions 8–9.
ku-dun	רווח		73	= *nēmelu*.
kid₇; *zar keše₂*	גדע; קשר אלומות		76	

Sumerian	Hebrew	Tag	Lines	Notes
dabin; *ka-gu₇*	סולת; מאכל (פה)		85, 86	
ne-ḫa	נח; הניח	[cognate] (*nēḫu*)	87, 96	§9.6 gate confirmed.
mar-gid₂-da; *mur*	עגלה; מספוא	[equivalent] ↔ ישעיהו כח:כז–כח	93, 94	
sur₁₂; *ĝiš-ba₉-ra₂*; *ba₉-ra₂*	גורן; מורג; דש / פתח	[equivalent] ↔ ישעיהו מא:טו	96–101	§9.3 confirmed (EWO 282 גֹּרֶן? now certain in context).
nir	זרה (vocalized נְזְרָתָה)	[equivalent] ↔ רות ג:ב	103, 107	
te-en (of the day)	הצטנן	[equivalent] ↔ בראשית ג:ח	108	Proverbs; open decision 12.
measures: *gur*, *ban₂*, *iku*, *nindan*, *šu-si*	כֹּר (open decision 3, settled); בָּאן; אִיקוּ; נִינְדָּן; אצבע		26–29, 46, 50–51, 73	

Key findings for the commentary

- **Isa 28:23–29 is the Farmer's Instructions in miniature.** The same sequence of work – ploughing in order to sow (יַחֲרֹשׁ הַחֹרֵשׁ לִזְרֹעַ, the seeder-plough, 41), harrowing (32 ,וְיִשַּׂדֵּד), levelling the surface (שְׁוָה פָּנֶיהָ = *sa₂*, 9), placing the seed in rows (וְשָׂם חִטָּה שׂוֹרָה = *ĝar*, 46, 49), threshing with sledge, cart-wheel and stick (86 ,93 ,99 ↔ בַּמַּטֶּה יֵחָבָט , אוֹפַן עָגָלָה , חָרוּץ), not threshing endlessly (לֹא לָנֶצַח אָדוֹשׁ ↔ the rests of 87, 96) – and the same claim at the end: the farmer's knowledge is a god's instruction (יוֹרֻנּוּ ↔ *na de₅*, 110; גַּם זֹאת מֵעִם יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת יָצָאָה ↔ "the instruction of Ninurta"). The Sumerian text is a school text c. 1800 BCE; Isaiah uses the genre as a parable.
- **Gen 3:17–19, 3:23, 4:2, 9:20: farming as sentence vs farming as teaching.** In Genesis the work of the ground follows the expulsion (לַעֲבֹד אֶת הָאֲדָמָה) and is בְּעִצָּבוֹן; the first farmers are men (Cain, Noah). Here the farmer is a god (111 ,אֹכֶר הַנָּאֱמָן שֶׁל אֱנְלִיל), the work is his instruction, weeds are routine (8), and well-planned work is done "as with a happy heart" (28). *saḫar* (the cognate of עָפָר) is only working soil (61–62). [divergence]

- **The gleaners (Lev 19:9; Deut 24:19; Ruth 2–3).** *de₅* = Akk. *laqātu* ~ לָקַט [cognate]: the "barley gleaners" (79, 82) stand beside the "small of strength" (82), and the father orders something done "according to their number" and "at / as sheaves" (83) – on one reading, provision for them to lie by the sheaves (Ruth 3:7) – after which "your work will be cared for truly" (84; cf. Deut 24:19's blessing). The gleaner beats out grain with a stick (86 ↔ Ruth 2:17 וַתַּחְבֹּט); the barley is winnowed at the threshing floor in the evening and at night, with prayer (103, 108 ↔ Ruth 3:2 זֹרֶה ... הַלַּיְלָה), and measured (107 ↔ Ruth 3:15).
- **Deut 22:10, 25:4.** The Sumerian team is oxen only, with spare oxen and ploughs (23–25); the oxen of the cart are fed (94); for the threshing oxen (100) no feeding is commanded – [absent] the Torah's לֹא תַחְסֹם.
- **Gen 8:22.** Sowing and harvest (49–52, 74–78), the cooling of the day and the night (108), the cold and heat (13: the field "cooks") – the agricultural year as a fixed order, but with no flood and no promise behind it.
- **Gen 1:14, 1:20.** "When the stars of heaven are right" (38) the plough-team goes out: the stars as מוֹעֲדִים of the farmer (and in Hesiod's *Works and Days*, a shared motif). The locust is written with the determinative of birds, {mušen} (66) – the Sumerian scribe classes it with the flying creatures by its motion, as Lev 11:20–22 counts the locust among שֶׁרֶץ הָעוֹף (cf. the commentary's עוֹף as the motion-word).
- **Deut 28:22, 38; Amos 4:9; 1 Kgs 8:37; 1 Sam 6:4–5; Joel 1.** Pests and blight: the rodents (prayer to their god Ninkilim, 65), the "tooth" of the locust (66 ↔ Joel 1:6 שִׁנָּיו שִׁנֵּי אַרְיֵה), the *samana* disease (71) – in the Bible punishments, here an agricultural risk (a watering too many) met by ritual and know-how.
- **Lev 23:14; 25:22; 26:10.** "Since there is still flour of old barley, let no one beat out the grain for your bread" (85–86): eating the old until the new, with the new grain not touched early – economic here, cultic (the omer) in Leviticus.
- **[absent]** Mixed sowing (Lev 19:19; Deut 22:9), the sabbatical year and the firstfruits have no counterpart in the text; nor does any "curse" of the ground.
- **The ancient mind.** The field is alive and has moods ("its angry places", 33); the grain is a goddess who "falls" into the furrow (50); a pest has a god who is prayed to (65); four prayers mark the year (65, 88, 103, 108); the threshing floor and the sheaves are given "rest" (87, 96, with the Akkadian loan *ne-ḫa* ~ נוח). And a very practical father: quotas and spares, a tenth more yield for a well-timed watering (73), keep an eye on the man who drops the seed (49), don't wait to be told (37), plan for 144 rather than 180 *iku* and the work will be "as with a happy heart" (27–28).

Parallels index (Farmer's Instructions)

Line	Sumerian	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
1	*ud-ul-ur₁₁-ru dumu-ni na mu-un-de₅-ga-am₃*	אוד־אול־אורו נתן עצה לבנו	וַיֹּרֵנִי וַיֹּאמֶר לִי (משלי ד:ד)	[equivalent]	A father instructs his son, the frame of Sumerian instruction literature (Šuruppag); *na de₅* = נתן עצה (2026-10-23 harmonization; was 9.3§ ,הוֹרָה). The teacher turns out to be a god (110).
4	*a-šag₄ a de₂-a-zu-ne*	כשאתה יוצק מים על השדה	וְהִשְׁקָה אֶת כָּל פְּנֵי הָאֲדָמָה (בראשית ב:ו)	[divergence]	Irrigation from below, as in Gen 2:6 – but poured and controlled by the farmer, not rising by itself.
5	*ud a-ta im-mu-e-a-ed₃-de₃-a*	ביום שהוא עולה מן המים	וְתַרְאֶה הַיַּבָּשָׁה (בראשית א:ט)	[divergence]	The field "comes up out of the water" every year after the flooding. Our proposal.
6	*en-nu-ûĝ₃ ak-ab*	משמר עשה	לְעָבְדָהּ וּלְשָׁמְרָהּ (בראשית ב:טו)	[equivalent]	The worked field is also guarded; a watchman's word (*en-nu-ûĝ₃* משמר), not a verb of work. Our proposal.
8	*u₂-saga₁₁-bi u₃-bi₂-ze₂*	אחרי שאת אגודות העשב שבו תלשת	וְקוֹץ וְדַרְדַּר תַּצְמִיחַ לָךְ (בראשית ג:יח)	[divergence]	Weeds are routine work (pulled out), not a curse.
9	*10-am₃ {urud}giĝ₄ sal 2/3 ma-na-ta sa₂-a-ab*	עשר פעמים בקרדום דק – השווה – ... (אותו)!	הֲלוֹא אִם שִׁוָּה פָנֶיהָ (ישעיהו כח:כה)	[equivalent]	Levelling the field before sowing; *sa₂* "make equal" = השווה (H&P). Our proposal.

Line	Sumerian	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
19	*{urud}giĝ₄ {urud}bulug {urud}šum-me*	קרדום, מרצע ומַשׁוֹר	לְלָטוֹשׁ אִישׁ אֶת מַחֲרַשְׁתּוֹ וְאֶת אִתּוֹ וְאֶת קַרְדֻּמּוֹ (שמואל א יג:כ)	[equivalent]	The farmer's copper tools and their upkeep by craftsmen (18).
15	*{ĝiš}šudul-zu … ḫa-ra-keše₂*	עולך – רתמותיו ייקשרו לך	לֹא תַחֲרֹשׁ בְּשׁוֹר וּבַחֲמֹר יַחְדָּו (דברים כב:י)	[divergence]	The yoke joins a team of oxen only (23–24): ox with ox.
23	*gud-{ĝiš}apin gud dirig-ga a-ab-tuku-a*	שור־ המחרשה – שור עודף יהיה לו	וְהוּא חֹרֵשׁ שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר צְמָדִים לְפָנָיו (מלכים א יט:יט)	[equivalent]	A large plough-team, with spare oxen and ploughs (23–25).
24	*gud gud-da dur bi₂-ib-tu-lu-a*	עֲבוֹת שור אל שור – רפוי יהיה	הֲתִתְקַשָּׁר רֵים בְּתֶלֶם עֲבֹתוֹ (איוב לט:י)	[equivalent]	The rope of the plough animal (*dur* = עֲבוֹת).
26	*eš₂-gar₃ {ĝiš}apin 1-e 180 iku-am₃*	מכסת מחרשה אחת – מאה ושמונים אִיקוּ היא	כַּלּוּ מַעֲשֵׂיכֶם דְּבַר יוֹם בְּיוֹמוֹ (שמות ה:יג)	[equivalent]	The assigned quota of work (*eš₂-gar₃* = מְכְסָה).
28	*a₂ šag₄ ḫul₂-gin₇ a-ra-ab-dim₂-e*	הכוח? – כבלב שמח – יעוצב לך	בְּעִצָּבוֹן תֹּאכְלֶנָּה כֹּל יְמֵי חַיֶּיךָ (בראשית ג:יז)	[divergence]	Well-planned field work is done "as with a happy heart". Our proposal.
32	*ĝiš ur₃-ra-ab ĝiš gi₄-a-ab ĝiš peš-bi₂-ib*	את העץ גרור! את העץ הָשֵׁב! את העץ שַׁלֵּשׁ!	יְפַתַּח וִישַׁדֵּד אַדְמָתוֹ (ישעיהו כח:כד)	[equivalent]	Harrowing after ploughing, three times; cf. שָׁנוּ וַיִּשְׁנוּ וַיֹּאמֶר שַׁלֵּשׁוּ וַיְשַׁלֵּשׁוּ (מלכים א יח:לד).

Line	Sumerian	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
37	*a-šag₄ kiĝ₂-zu ak na-an-na-ab-be₂*	"– את השדה – את עבודתך – אל עשה!" – אל יאמרו לו	מֵחֹרֶף עָצֵל לֹא יַחֲרֹשׁ (משלי כ:ד)	[equivalent]	The ploughman who needs no prodding vs the sluggard who does not plough.
38	*ud mul-an-na šu im-ma-ab-du₇-a-ta*	מן היום שכוכבי השמים את היד השלימו	וְהָיוּ לְאֹתֹת וּלְמוֹעֲדִים וּלְיָמִים וְשָׁנִים (בראשית א:יד)	[equivalent]	The stars fix the farmer's season (also Hesiod, *Works and Days*: a shared motif).
41	*a-šag₄ ur₁₁-ru-da-zu-ne*	כשאתה עומד לחרוש את השדה	הֲכֹל הַיּוֹם יַחֲרֹשׁ הַחֹרֵשׁ לְזָרֹעַ (ישעיהו כח:כד)	[equivalent]	Ploughing in order to sow: the Sumerian seeder-plough (ORACC glosses *uru₄* "sow").
46	*1 nindan us₂ ab-sin₂ 8 gub-ba-ab*	על נִינְדָּן אחד של צד – שמונה תלמים העמד!	וְשָׂם חִטָּה שׂוֹרָה (ישעיהו כח:כה)	[equivalent]	Sowing in rows at a fixed spacing.
49	*lu₂ še-numun ĝar-ra-zu igi-zu ĝar-i₃*	על האיש השָׂם את זרע־השעורה שלך – את עינך שִׂים!	וְשָׂם חִטָּה שׂוֹרָה וּשְׂעֹרָה נִסְמָן (ישעיהו כח:כה)	[equivalent]	The sower "places" the seed: *ĝar* = שָׂם (reserved), the verb of Isa 28:25. Also זֶרַע וְקָצִיר (בראשית ח:כב).
50	*2 šu-si-ta-am₃ {d}ezina₂ ḫe₂-en-šub*	שתי (בעומק) אצבעות – דָּגָן תיפול!	כִּי לֹא הִמְטִיר יְהוָה אֱלֹהִים עַל הָאָרֶץ (בראשית ב:ה)	[divergence]	The grain is a goddess dropped into the furrow by man; no rain in the picture. Our proposal.
53	*{ĝiš}eme-{ĝiš}apin-na-zu*	לשון־מחרשתך	וְכִתְּתוּ חַרְבוֹתָם לְאִתִּים (ישעיהו ב:ד)	[equivalent]	The ploughshare (אֵת) is the plough's "tongue" (*eme*).

Line	Sumerian	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
61	*ki-saḫar us₂-bi*	במקום־העפר הסמוך	כִּי עָפָר אַתָּה וְאֶל עָפָר תָּשׁוּב (בראשית ג:יט)	[divergence]	*saḫar* (the cognate of עָפָר via Akk. *eperu*) is only the farmer's working soil.
64	*ud ḫenbur₂-e ki im-ma-ab-dar-ra-ta*	מן היום שהנצר את הארץ בקע	וַתּוֹצֵא הָאָרֶץ דֶּשֶׁא (בראשית א:יב)	[divergence]	The shoot splits the earth (*ki dar*); in Genesis the earth brings forth.
65	*sizkur₂ {d}nin-kilim-ke₄ dug₄-ga-ab*	את תפילת נִין־כִּילִים – אמור!	וְצַלְמֵי עַכְבְּרֵיכֶם הַמַּשְׁחִיתִם אֶת הָאָרֶץ (שמואל א ו:ה)	[divergence]	A rodent plague met by ritual: a prayer to the vermin's own god vs golden mice sent to Israel's God.
66	*zu₂ bir₅{mušen}-ra bal-e-eb*	את שן הארבה – הַפֹּךְ!	שְׁנֵּי שְׁנֵי אַרְיֵה (יואל א:ו)	[equivalent]	The locust's "tooth"; *bir₅* ~ Akk. *erbû* ~ אַרְבֶּה [cognate].
66	*bir₅{mušen}*	ארבה	כֹּל שֶׁרֶץ הָעוֹף הַהֹלֵךְ עַל אַרְבַּע (ויקרא יא:כ)	[equivalent]	The locust is written with the determinative of birds: classed with the flying creatures by its motion, as Lev 11:20–22 (אֶת הָאַרְבֶּה לְמִינוֹ). Our proposal.
68	*a numun saĝ-ĝa₂-ke₄ dug₄-ga-ab*	את מי זרע־הראש – השקה!	תְּלָמֶיהָ רַוֵּה נַחֵת גְּדוּדֶיהָ (תהלים סה:יא)	[divergence]	The furrows watered – by canal in Sumer, by rain in the psalm.
70	*še lillan-ba a dug₄-ga-ab*	את השעורה בִּמְלִילוֹתֶיהָ – השקה –!	וְקָטַפְתָּ מְלִילֹת בְּיָדֶךָ (דברים כג:כו)	[equivalent]	The full ears.

Line	Sumerian	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
71	*sa-ma-na₂-aš ba-gig*	בסָמָנָה חָלְתָה	וּבַשִּׁדָּפוֹן וּבַיֵּרָקוֹן (דברים כח:כב)	[equivalent]	A grain disease; in the Bible a punishment (הִכֵּיתִי אֶתְכֶם בַּשִּׁדָּפוֹן וּבַיֵּרָקוֹן (עמוס ד:ט)), here the result of a mistimed watering.
73	*1 sila₃ še ku-dun ba-tuku-tuku*	קב שעורה אחד של רֶוַח יהיה לה	וַיִּמְצָא בַּשָּׁנָה הַהִוא מֵאָה שְׁעָרִים (בראשית כו:יב)	[divergence]	A measured tenth more vs a hundredfold blessing.
74	*še gur₁₀-gur₁₀-ru-da-zu-ne*	כשאתה עומד לקצור את השעורה	זֶרַע וְקָצִיר (בראשית ח:כב)	[equivalent]	Sowing (49–52) and harvest (74–78).
75	*ud a₂-ba-ka gur₁₀-gur₁₀-ra-ab*	ביום עִתָּהּ – קצור וקצור!	שְׁבֻעֹת חֻקּוֹת קָצִיר יִשְׁמָר לָנוּ (ירמיהו ה:כד)	[equivalent]	The right time of harvest.
76	*u₃ lu₂ zar keše₂-da 1-am₃*	ואיש קושר אלומות – אחד	וְהִנֵּה אֲנַחְנוּ מְאַלְּמִים אֲלֻמִּים (בראשית לז:ז)	[equivalent]	The harvest team of three (76–78).
79	*lu₂ še de₅-de₅-ga-zu*	מלקט השעורה שלך	וְלֶקֶט קְצִירְךָ לֹא תְלַקֵּט (ויקרא יט:ט)	[cognate]	*de₅* = Akk. *laqātu* ~ לָקַט; here the farmer's own gatherers ("your").
82	*usu di₄-di₄-la₂-zu-ne u₃ lu₂ še de₅-de₅-ga-zu-ne*	קטני־האון(ל) שלך ו(ל)מלקטי השעורה שלך	וַתְּלַקֵּט בַּשָּׂדֶה אַחֲרֵי הַקֹּצְרִים (רות ב:ג)	[cognate]	The weak and the gleaners in the field, after the reapers (76–78).

Line	Sumerian	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
83	*zar-re-eš₂ nu₂-a-ab?*	לאלומות – הַשְׁכֵּב?!	וַיָּבֹא לִשְׁכַּב בִּקְצֵה הָעֲרֵמָה (רות ג:ז)	[equivalent]	One reading: let them lie by the sheaves (cf. גַּם בֵּין הָעֲמָרִים תְּלַקֵּט (רות ב:טו); ETCSL: "lay down the sheaves". Our proposal; open decision 7.
84	*kiĝ₂-zu mi₂ zid ḫa-ra-ab-dug₄*	את עבודתך – טיפוח של אמת יטפחו לך	לְמַעַן יְבָרֶכְךָ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ בְּכֹל מַעֲשֵׂה יָדֶיךָ (דברים כד:יט)	[divergence]	After the provision for the weak and the gleaners, "your work" is cared for; a blessing is at most implicit.
85	*dabin še sumun-e tuku-a-ta*	מאחר שסולת משעורה ישנה יש (להם)	וַאֲכַלְתֶּם יָשָׁן נוֹשָׁן (ויקרא כו:י)	[equivalent]	Living on the old grain until the new (also Lev 25:22).
86	*lu₂ še ĝiš na-ab-ra-ra-an*	איש את השעורה במקל אל יחבוט	וַתַּחְבֹּט אֵת אֲשֶׁר לִקֵּטָה (רות ב:יז)	[equivalent]	Beating out grain with a stick (also כִּי בַּמַּטֶּה יֵחָבֶט קֶצַח (ישעיהו כח:כז)).
86	*ka-gu₇-zu-še₃ … na-ab-ra-ra-an*	למאכל פיך … אל יחבוט	וְלֶחֶם וְקָלִי וְכַרְמֶל לֹא תֹאכְלוּ עַד עֶצֶם הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה (ויקרא כג:יד)	[divergence]	The new grain not used early: an economic rule here, a cultic one (the omer) in Leviticus.
87	*še-zar-ra ne-ḫa-ab*	לאלומות־ השעורה – הָנַח!	לְמַעַן יָנוּחַ שׁוֹרְךָ וַחֲמֹרֶךָ (שמות כג:יב)	[cognate]	*ne-ḫa* < Akk. *nēḫu* ~ נוח; rest given to the sheaves.
93	*{ĝiš}mar-gid₂-da-zu si ḫa-ra-ab-sa₂*	עגלתך – תְּיֻשַּׁר לך	וְאוֹפַן עֲגָלָה עַל כַּמּוֹן יוּסָב (ישעיהו כח:כז)	[equivalent]	The farmer's cart at the harvest and threshing.

Line	Sumerian	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
94	*gud {ĝiš}mar-gid₂-da-zu mur gu₇-bi₂-ib*	את שוורי עגלתך – מספוא האכל!	יוֹדֵעַ צַדִּיק נֶפֶשׁ בְּהֶמְתּוֹ (משלי יב:י)	[equivalent]	Feeding the working oxen.
96	*sur₁₂ du₈-a-zu ud 5-am₃ ŋa-ba-ne-ŋa*	הגורן שפרשת – חמישה ימים תנוח!	וַיָּנַח בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי (שמות כ:י)	[cognate]	The threshing floor "rests" five days (ETCSL: "a few"); *ne-ŋa* ~ נוח.
99	*zu₂ ĝiš-ba₉-ra₂-zu … esir₂ ŋa-ra-ab-sub₆-sub₆*	שיני מורגך … בחֵמָר – ימרחו וימרחו לך!	הִנֵּה שַׂמְתִּיךְ לְמוֹרַג חָרוּץ חָדָשׁ בַּעַל פִּיפִיּוֹת (ישעיהו מא:טו)	[equivalent]	The toothed threshing sledge (also וְהַמֹּרְגִים וּכְלֵי הַבָּקָר (שמואל ב כד:כב)).
99	*esir₂ ŋa-ra-ab-sub₆-sub₆*	בחֵמָר ימרחו	וַתַּחְמְרָה בַחֵמָר וּבְזָפֶת (שמות ב:ג)	[equivalent]	Coating with bitumen (*esir₂* = חֵמָר, cross-corpus).
100	*gud dur₂-dur₂-ru-da-zu-ne*	כשאתה עומד להושיב את השוורים	לֹא תַחְסֹם שׁוֹר בְּדִישׁוֹ (דברים כה:ד)	[absent]	Threshing with oxen; no command to let the threshing ox eat (the cart oxen are fed, 94).
103	*sizkur₂ še nu-nir-ra dug₄-ga-ab*	את תפילת השעורה שלא נִזְרְתָה – אמור!	הִנֵּה הוּא זֹרֶה אֶת גֹּרֶן הַשְּׂעֹרִים הַלָּיְלָה (רות ג:ב)	[equivalent]	Winnowing barley on the threshing floor, with prayer in the evening and at night (108).
107	*ud še ba-e-nir-ra ĝidru-še₃ nu₂-a-ab*	ביום שהשעורה נִזְרְתָה – אל השרביט הַשְּׁכֵּב!	וַיָּמָד שֵׁשׁ שְׂעֹרִים (רות ג:טו)	[equivalent]	Measuring the winnowed barley.
108	*sizkur₂ a₂ ud te-en ĝi₆-ba dug₄-ga-ab*	את התפילה לעת שהיום מצטנן, בלילה – אמור!	מִתְהַלֵּךְ בַּגָּן לְרוּחַ הַיּוֹם (בראשית ג:ח)	[equivalent]	"The cooling of the day" = the evening breeze.

Line	Sumerian	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
108	*ud … ĝi₆-ba*	היום … בלילה	וְיוֹם וָלַיְלָה לֹא יִשְׁבֹּתוּ (בראשית ח:כב)	[equivalent]	Day and night in one line.
110	*na de₅-ga {d}nin-urta dumu {d}en-lil₂-la₂-ke₄*	העצה שנתן נִינוּרְתָּה, בְּנוֹ שֶׁל אֶנְלִיל	וְיִסְרוֹ לַמִּשְׁפָּט אֱלֹהָיו יוֹרֶנּוּ (ישעיהו כח:כו)	[equivalent]	The farmer's work as a god's instruction; the whole sequence of Isa 28:23–29 (see Key findings).
110	(same)	(same)	גַּם זֹאת מֵעִם יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת יָצְאָה הִפְלִא עֵצָה הִגְדִּיל תּוּשִׁיָּה (ישעיהו כח:כט)	[equivalent]	The parable's last line = the text's colophon; since the 2026-10-23 harmonization in the same word too (עצה).
110	(same)	(same)	וַיְשַׁלְּחֵהוּ יְהוָה אֱלֹהִים מִגַּן עֵדֶן לַעֲבֹד אֶת הָאֲדָמָה (בראשית ג:כג)	[divergence]	Farming as a sentence (Genesis) vs farming as divine teaching (Sumer).
111	*{d}nin-urta engar zid {d}en-lil₂-la₂*	נינורתה, אִכָּרוֹ הַנֶּאֱמָן שֶׁל אֶנְלִיל	וַיָּחֶל נֹחַ אִישׁ הָאֲדָמָה (בראשית ט:כ)	[divergence]	The first farmer: a god here, a man (Noah; Cain, וְקַיִן הָיָה עֹבֵד אֲדָמָה (בראשית ד:ב)) in Genesis. Formula = S&W 317.
111	*engar*	אִכָּר	אִכָּרִים וְכֹרְמִים בָּהָרִים וּבַכַּרְמֶל (דברי הימים ב כו:י)	[cognate]	Sum. *engar* > Akk. *ikkaru* > אִכָּר.

Progress

- 2026-10-22: drafting (one translator, sequentially), each section saved at once and checked (`verify 5`, `check_bible_quotes.py`): 1–13, 14–22, 23–40, 41–63, 64–73, 74–88, 89–109, 110–111 – **all 111 lines**. Verses quoted from memory were caught and fixed (the Jer 5:24 ketiv `וּרָה`; a stray Amos reference in 75); every verse was then printed (`--show`) before quoting.
- 2026-10-22: `translation--intro.rtl.md` written; `python3 -I sumerian_tools.py build 5` → 111 lines, 5 footnotes (41, 66, 83, 110, 111).
- 2026-10-22: review pass (a) fidelity (Hebrew against the transliteration, line by line): added words marked `( )` (21 `(לו)`, `(ל)` 82 , `(בה)` 42); `בצד` → `לצדך` 22 (no "your" in *da*); 45 *tal₂* made intransitive (`זרוע תרחב ותרחב`); 59 punctuation; 93 `.` as 58 (same form).
- 2026-10-22: review pass (b) consistency: every recurring Sumerian word and frame compared by string across the file (decisions 2, 8); `renderings.md` written from the drafted lines and checked by script (each row's "Check" string in every listed line: 111 rows, 0 misses); line 111's formula checked byte-identical with S&W 317.
- 2026-10-22: review pass (c) Hebrew (the clean translation read aloud in full): no further changes; register even; the reserved-string traps avoided (`תתן` , `להושיב` , `לראשך`).
- 2026-10-22: **`verify 5 --strict`: OK** (111 entries, no "same transliteration, different Hebrew"); **`check_bible_quotes.py` on `annotated.rtl.md`, `translation--intro.rtl.md`, `project.md`: 0 problems.**
- Not done here (outside this folder): the print stub `../../-5/הדפסה/סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים-האיכר-הוראות.rtl.md`, the merge into `../parallels-index.md` and `../renderings.md` (coordinator).